Maps and Atlases

H 1865

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A. Background

Map headings are assigned not only to maps and atlases, but also to works about maps and atlases, and to works with both textual and cartographic content in which the cartographic content is secondary, serving mainly to support, illustrate, or explain the textual content. This instruction sheet discusses the assignment of headings to works of this latter type in order to bring out their cartographic content. For instructions on providing subject access to maps themselves, see the *Map Cataloging Manual*.

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Textbooks***. To replace a form subdivision that includes a demographic group, also assign Library of Congress Demographic Groups Terms (LCDGT) to bring out the audience of the resource being cataloged, e.g. ***German speakers*** or ***Arabic, Students of***.

For guidelines on assigning LCGFT, see the *LCGFT Manual* J 215 *Cartographic Materials*.

B. Recent revisions

2026-01: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

C. General rule

Assign the appropriate map heading(s) if at least 20% of the text of a work consists of maps, or discusses maps, even though the primary emphasis of the work is on the textual content.

Example

```
650 #0 $a Aeronautical charts.
650 #0 $a City planning $z Washington (State) $z Seattle $v Maps.
```

LC practice:

```
650 #0 $a Aeronautical charts.
650 #0 $a City planning $z Washington (State) $z Seattle.
655 #7 $a Aeronautical charts. $2 lcgft
```

Example

```
651 #0 $a Washington (D.C.) $v Maps.
```

LC practice:

```
651 #0 $a Washington (D.C.)
655 #7 $a Maps. $2 lcgft
```

Assign the heading(s) specified above in addition to the headings that are assigned to designate the textual content of the work.

G. Incidental maps

Do not bring out the presence of maps in the text if the maps in question are of an incidental or routine nature.

Revision history

2026-01: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.